Northamptonshire County Badminton Association

SQUAD MEMBERSHIP AGREEMENT

2026 – 2027

The primary purpose of county squad training sessions is to develop the skills, knowledge, attitude and resilience required to play competitive badminton and represent Northamptonshire County with distinction.

By accepting a place within a Northamptonshire County Squad, players commit to working hard, behaving appropriately and striving to improve their badminton performance throughout the season. Squad places are limited and acceptance of a place carries a responsibility to make the most of the opportunities provided.

Regular attendance at training sessions is expected. Continued membership of a squad may be reviewed where attendance, commitment or conduct falls below an acceptable standard. Player progress and engagement may be assessed periodically throughout the season.

Players are expected to:

- Play within the rules and laws of badminton and respect officials, coaches, volunteers and opponents at all times.
- Aspire to represent Northamptonshire County in matches and competitions when selected.
- Attend county training sessions regularly and engage positively with all coaching activities.
- Demonstrate commitment to their badminton development through participation in appropriate competitive opportunities, including county events, local competitions, club leagues and Badminton England-sanctioned tournaments where appropriate.
- Maintain a level of competitive activity sufficient to support their development and allow coaches to assess performance and progress.
- Wear appropriate county kit when representing Northamptonshire County and whenever reasonably requested at county events.
- Act as ambassadors for Northamptonshire County Badminton both on and off court.
- The Head Coach may, in exceptional circumstances, make individual adjustments to participation expectations where this is considered appropriate and in the best interests of the player and/or Northamptonshire County Badminton.

Attendance and Punctuality

- Players are expected to arrive promptly for all training sessions, matches and county activities.
- Players should notify their Squad Coach as early as possible if they are unable to attend or expect to arrive late.
- Consistent non-attendance without reasonable explanation may result in a review of squad membership and selection opportunities.

Attitude and Behaviour

- Players must be polite, courteous and respectful to fellow players, coaches, volunteers, officials, parents and opponents at all times.
- Players must contribute positively to the squad environment.
- Players should be prepared to assist with setting up and clearing away equipment when requested.
- Bullying, discrimination, abusive behaviour or conduct likely to bring Northamptonshire County Badminton into disrepute will not be tolerated.

Mobile Phones and Electronic Devices

- Mobile phones, smart watches and other electronic devices should not be used during training sessions.
- Players are expected to remain focused and engaged in training activities at all times.
- Mobile phones should be switched to silent mode and stored away during sessions unless otherwise instructed.
- The use of mobile phones, tablets or other recording devices will only be permitted where they are being used as part of the coaching programme and with the prior approval of the Head Coach.
- Players may be asked to use electronic devices for video analysis, performance review or other coaching purposes where directed by the Head Coach or coaching team.
- Unauthorised photography, filming, audio recording or social media activity during training sessions is not permitted.
- Repeated breaches of this policy may result in disciplinary action or a review of squad membership.

Dress Code

- Suitable badminton footwear must be worn at all training sessions and matches.
- Fashion trainers, outdoor footwear or black-soled shoes are not permitted.
- Players should wear appropriate badminton clothing for training and competition.
- County shirts should be worn when attending county matches, tournaments and official county events unless otherwise advised.

Coaches are expected to:

- Provide a safe, inclusive and positive environment for all players.
- Deliver coaching and training programmes designed to support player development.
- Arrange and manage county match opportunities where practicable.
- Promote appropriate competitive opportunities, including local and Badminton England-sanctioned events.
- Teach technical, tactical, physical and mental aspects of the game.
- Support players in achieving their individual goals and potential.
- Operate in accordance with Badminton England safeguarding, disciplinary and conduct policies.

Parents / Guardians are expected to:

- Encourage their child to enjoy badminton and compete fairly.
- Support coaches, officials and volunteers in creating a positive environment.
- Respect officials' decisions and discourage unsporting behaviour.
- Encourage effort, learning and personal development as well as results.
- Ensure their child arrives on time for training sessions, matches and competitions.
- Inform coaches of any absence as early as possible.
- Provide transport to and from training sessions, matches and competitions where required.
- Assist with county events, matches and competitions where reasonably requested.
- Collect their child promptly at the end of each session.
- Be aware that video analysis may be used as part of the coaching programme.
- Be aware that a player's name, results and photographs may be used on Northamptonshire County Badminton websites, social media platforms, newsletters, promotional materials and local media reports.

Data and Media Consent

If a parent/guardian objects to the use of a player's name, image or video footage for county-related purposes, they should notify the Secretary in writing.

Agreement

By signing this document, the player and parent/guardian acknowledge that they have read, understood and agree to abide by this Squad Membership Agreement and all relevant Northamptonshire County Badminton policies.

Signatures

Player Name: _____ Parent / Guardian Name _____

Player Signature: _____ Parent / Guardian Signature _____

Date: _____ Date: _____

Northampton County Badminton Association

Training & Holiday Schedule

September 2026 – July 2027

This information sheet should be kept by Northants County players / parents as a record of all training and holiday dates from September 2026 to July 2027

Block Dates 2026 - 2027		
Term 1a	07.09.26 – 19.10.26	7 weeks
Half term	26-30th October 2026	No training
Term 1b	2.11.26 – 18.12.26	7 weeks
Christmas Break	19.12.25 – 03.01.27	No training (2 weeks)
Term 2a	04.01.27 – 05.02.27	5 weeks
Half term	8th – 12th February 2027	No training
Term 2b	15.02.27 – 26.03.27	6 weeks
Easter Break	27.03.27 – 11.04.27	No training (2 weeks)
Term 3a	12.04.27 – 28.05.27	7 weeks
Half term	31st May – 4th June 2027	No training
Term 3b	07.06.27 – 16.07.27	6 weeks
Summer Break	17.07.27	